

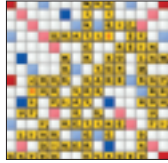
Hack Your Brain

Mitch Altman has made a brain machine that induces hallucinations, nirvana or deep sleep cycles using LEDs that flash into your eyes along with alpha, beta, theta and delta sonic pulses phased to your brain through the ear. This is a piece of open-source hardware from the guy who made TV-B-Gone



Facebook Bans Scrabulous

The popular Facebook application Scrabulous was banned on all facebook networks across the world, except in India, from where it originated. The app by Jayant and Rajat Agarwalla was used by ten times as many people as Mattel and Hasbro's official scrabble app. Luckily, Indians are the only people in the world who get to play it



Escape

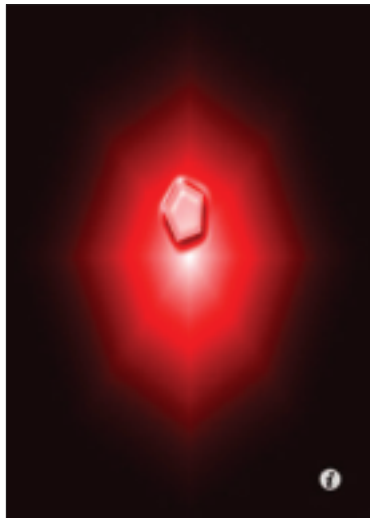
WHO NEEDS SWAROVSKI?

The \$1000 iPhone App

There have been ridiculously priced tech products around ever since people had the money to spend on them, but this one takes it to an entirely different level. The iPhone was more or less a status symbol till the skimming tactics got the prices low enough for a lot of people to afford one, and along comes a German fellow called Armin Heinrich who puts together an iPhone app that displays a red gemstone with a glowing effect and puts it on sale on the iPhone online app store for \$999.99, which is the most any software developer is allowed to charge for an app on the store.

The app is called i-am-rich, and does not do anything else. So in effect, for a little less than a thousand dollars, you get an icon on your iPhone that proclaims your richness. The miserable excuse for an app, for reasons unknown was removed from the store, without any explanation being given to the developer or the users.

That was however, not before eight people bought it, six from the United States and one each from France and Germany—all within the twenty four



hours for which the app was available. The application is still available on the developer's Web site, by special request over e-mail. Message boards on blogs discussing this scam/brilliant marketing gimmick/exceptional exercise in human psychology are awash with posts of those who want to offer a look-alike for \$1 or the \$1500 i-am-richer iPhone app, but the original stands without being equalled.

Heinrich didn't receive the amount that is due to him from the site, but that is probably because there were some purchases made by mistake or after thinking the application was a joke. Despite the 'all sales final' policy, Heinrich has offered to return the money of those who have

purchased the app by mistake, but he has to get the \$5,600 he has earned first. Those people who now own the app, are really happy about how exclusive it is, and have said so in their mails to the developer.

SHORTSIGHTED SEER

Bill Gates Predicts The Future; Or The Past

Bill Gates is often called a stealer of ideas, and accused of indulging in less than ethical business practices. He's also infamous for his sometimes awry predictions—"640 K ought to be enough for everybody," which to be honest was probably wrongly attributed to him. It's probably all that money that he's surrounded by that causes jealousy and the need for such rumours.

However, his latest prediction, some say, suggests that he's retired just in time... Addressing a gathering of 1,600 researchers, developers and academics in Hong Kong, Bill Gates shared his "vision" about the future of computer use. This was a seminar marking the tenth anniversary of Microsoft, at their Asian research wing.

Whatever Happened To... 64-bit Computing

A bit is the most fundamental unit of data, either a 0 or a 1. A 32-bit processor is the norm, and they can process data units that are 32-bits or 4 octets wide. A 64-bit processor, can handle data units twice as wide, i.e. 8 octets, and therefore promise faster computers.

64-bit computing has been around since the sixties, and at the turn of the century, it looked as if they would replace the 32-bit processors in the PC market. Intel's Itanium, AMD's Athlon 64 and Apple's G5 were all competing with each other to establish themselves in the 64-bit market—only, there was no market. All the hype fizzled out, and 64-bit computing has been stuck in limbo ever since. The biggest benefit of 64-bit computing was also its biggest problem. A 32-bit processor can use up to 4 gigabytes of RAM, with 2 GB allotted to the OS and 2 GB for the applications. A 64-bit processor, on the other hand can handle 16 billion gigabytes—there is simply no need for it.

The transition from 16-bit to 32-bit happened in the heydays of Windows, and was pretty smooth. However, changing over to 64-bit is much trickier process. Video content and Gaming stand to benefit the most in the changeover, and will be the driving forces, if and when it happens. There will always be a need for more computation power—and no one will put an upper limit on this.

DigiPick
of the month

Call Airtel on XXX-XXXX-XXX for help



Last month's winner:
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Participate and win next month:
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WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with "DigiPick" in the subject line, mentioning your postal address, on or before the 20th of this month to digipick@thinkdigit.com. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

He looked far into the future and discussed the various transformations that he expects in technology. He noted how the increasing connectivity to the Internet will allow for more development of server-based technology. "People often talk about this as the Internet service revolution, that will eventually lead to machines that have lots of server capacity, lots of low-cost computing, low-cost storage and that will let us write software in an even more ambitious way, eliminating the last constraints we have." Reading between the lines, it means that in the future, Microsoft hopes to catch up with Google and offer services on the lines of Google apps.

His other gem was about touch screen appliances being everywhere, "because they're fairly developed in the labs, I can say that in 10 years (they) will be widespread." Yes, he did say "In ten years, they will be

fairly widespread," in case you thought you read wrong. In another interview, for BBC, he said "I'll be brave, in five years we'll have many tens of million of people sitting browsing their photos, browsing their music, organising their lives using this type of touch interface."

Err... Mr Gates, it's called an iPhone or an iPod Touch, and millions are already using such devices.

Some other Gates gems include "I believe OS/2 is destined to be the most important operating system, and possibly program, of all time."

It's sad really, because a lot of Linux fanboys and general Microsoft bashers now get to add more fuel to the already raging anti-Microsoft fire. On some forum a member seems to have the last laugh, "Hell, what do you expect from a person who never saw the end of the millenium coming." This was in reference to the Y2K bug.

PSYCHOTECH

The Spam King Is Dead

In 2002 Edward "Eddie" Davidson started an Internet promotions company known as "Power Promoters". Between 2002 and 2005, Davidson's company specialised in sending thousands of unsolicited e-mails advertising watches, perfumes, penny stocks and other products. He lied and misguided about the products in his mails, increasing their apparent value. The voluminous nature of his activities earned him the title of "Spam King."

On December 3, 2007 he plead guilty in a US Court. By April 2008, after many hearings, he was judged guilty by US District Court Judge Marcia S. Krieger and sentenced to two years in prison. Some of his ill-gotten gains including property and gold coins were forfeited, and he was ordered to pay

People Who Changed Computing

Paul V. Mockapetris

Jimmy Wales was the guy who turned around the concept of the mob mentality by using it for fruitful purposes. In retrospect it may seem like a simple idea, but Wikipedia was an



Jimmy Wales

important breakthrough on how efforts of various individuals are collaborated over the Internet, and paved the way for many technologies that are called 'Web 2.0'.

Born in 1966, Wales began by working on Nupedia, which was like any encyclopaedia—experts were called in to write articles, and peers would review it. There was only one major distinction, it was free. Wales hired Larry Sanger to be the editor-in-chief for the Nupedia project.

Larry Sanger had the idea of using the wiki script to make the encyclopaedia editable by anyone. Wikipedia spread like wildfire, more than doubling in size every year. The free multilingual open content encyclopaedia was born. In 2006, Time magazine named him on the list of the most influential people in the world.